

Tax & Depreciation Essentials Checklist — Investors (Northern Territory)

What to have in place — and why the NT is structurally different from every other Australian jurisdiction.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — this is NOT financial, tax or legal advice. Always engage a qualified accountant or tax agent for advice specific to your situation.

Section 1 — Records to Keep From Day One

- ☐ [] **A tax depreciation schedule from a qualified quantity surveyor** — Division 43 (building) and Division 40 (plant and equipment) deductions. These are federal (Commonwealth) tax matters, so they apply in the NT exactly as they do everywhere else in Australia.
- ☐ [] **Receipts for repairs vs. improvements — kept separately.** Repairs are often immediately deductible; improvements form part of your CGT cost base.
- ☐ [] **Stamp duty receipts.**
- ☐ [] **Records of your accountant fees and depreciation schedule costs.**

Section 2 — The NT's Unique State/Territory Tax Position

- ☐ [] **Understand there's no land tax to budget for.** The Northern Territory is the only Australian state or territory with **no general land tax** — this means your ongoing state-level holding costs are structurally lower than an equivalent property anywhere else in Australia.
- ☐ [] **Understand there's no foreign buyer surcharge either.** Unlike every state and the ACT, the NT charges **no additional duty surcharge for foreign purchasers** — foreign buyers pay identical rates to Australian citizens.
- ☐ [] **Don't confuse "no land tax" with "no property-related state taxes at all."** You'll still pay standard transfer (stamp) duty at purchase, calculated via the NT's formula-based system for properties under \$525,000 and tiered flat rates above that threshold.
- ☐ [] **Check whether the House and Land Package Exemption (HLPE) applied to your purchase** if you bought via a single house-and-land contract — this could mean you paid no duty at all, which affects your cost base calculations for CGT purposes later.

Section 3 — Understanding the Changing CGT Environment (Federal, Applies Everywhere)

- ☐ [] **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing**, with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from **1 July 2027** — this is a federal change and applies to NT property exactly as it does elsewhere in Australia. Confirm the finalised current position with your accountant.
- ☐ [] **If planning to sell, get advice on timing relative to the 2027 changeover.**

Section 4 — Depreciation Schedule Timing

- ☐ [] **Get your depreciation schedule prepared as early as possible after settlement.**
- ☐ [] **Update it after any renovations or major asset additions.**
- ☐ [] **Don't assume an older NT property has no deductions available** — plant and equipment deductions can still apply, and given the NT's climate, air conditioning systems are often a particularly significant depreciable asset worth confirming with your quantity surveyor.

Section 5 — Questions to Bring to Your Accountant

- ☐ [] Given there's no NT land tax, is my overall investment strategy optimised to take advantage of the lower ongoing holding costs (e.g. does this change my hold-vs-sell calculus compared to a similar property interstate)?
- ☐ [] Did I benefit from the HLPE duty waiver, and how does that affect my cost base?
- ☐ [] How will the 2027 CGT changes affect a future sale of this property?
- ☐ [] Is my depreciation schedule up to date with any renovations or asset purchases since it was last prepared?

Quick Reference — NT Investor Tax Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax	None — unique in Australia
Foreign buyer surcharge	None — unique in Australia
Standard transfer duty	Formula-based (<\$525,000) / tiered flat rates (≥\$525,000)
HLPE duty waiver	Full waiver on eligible single-contract packages, until 30 June 2027
CGT discount changes	Cost-base indexation + minimum tax from 1 July 2027 (federal, applies nationally)

© HouseHQ. General information only, current as at the date shown. This is not financial, tax or legal advice. Always engage a qualified accountant or registered tax agent for advice specific to your circumstances.